Alongside, a state-sponsored embankment was built across the river. The likely locale of the lake and the remnants of the embankment were identified by Khan Bahadur Ardeseer Jamsedjee, the Naib Diwan of the princely state of Junagadh, in the nineteenth century.[11] He believed two dams had been constructed, one in the reign of Rudradaman and an earlier one in Chandragupta's. The Mauryan dam was older and smaller and he sought to identify it with the blocks of masonry in the bed of the Sonarekha river near the Dharagir gate of the city, in whose vicinity there were mounds. While the dam is no longer visible, the description given by Jamsedjee suggests what it looked like in the nineteenth century:

> From the top of the mound on the right or north bank it was clear the blocks of masonry were remains of a dam that once lay across the river and stretched westward till it joined the easternmost spur of the Uparkot rocks. Surely this was the original Chandragupta dam of which we were in search. The length of the gap or breach in the dam is 36 yards. Of the mound that ran from the right bank of the Sonrekha to the Jogini spurs few traces remain. The height near the river bank is about thirty feet. The length of the embankment or west side of the river between the bed and the Citadel was 314 yards. Of this about 140 yards of masonry remain; 174 have been carried away for building. The breadth of the masonry varies from 43 to 53 yards.[12]

The lake that was created behind this embankment would have covered some 140 acres. Jamsedjee also attempted to identify the conduits or sluices that Rudradaman's inscription mentions as a feature of the renovations carried out by Ashoka. In the Dharagir garden he found labourers excavating huge blocks of stone which formed a pavement hollow in the centre, and which passed northwards from the bank of the lake. This had the appearance of being the remains of a conduit or canal. Clearly, keeping the bund in working order had been ensured by Ashoka's administration. The dam being in this area, one edge of the lake would have been in the vicinity of the Girnar rock.[13] Such a landscape, created, altered, and sustained by Ashoka and his predecessors, will have been seen and experienced as a symbol of the power of the dynasty in improving the lives of its citizens,